WEIGHTED EVALS · SAMPLE EVALUATION · OCTOBER 2026

On our invoice tests, the cheapest model was just as accurate

We tested three AI models on an invoice-review agent. Across 24 test invoices, each run 3 times, the budget model made every payment decision correctly, the same as the models from Google and OpenAI, at less than 1.5% of their cost per invoice.

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100%
correct payment decisions for all three models (216 of 216 runs)

98.5%
lower model cost with the budget model, vs. either alternative

0
critical errors, such as paying a risky invoice

Model cost is what the AI provider bills to run the agent: the ongoing operating cost, not the cost of this evaluation.

What we tested

- **The job:** an AI agent reviews supplier invoices for a fictional distributor and decides to approve, hold, or flag each one, with a short note explaining why.
- **The test:** 24 realistic scenarios (clean invoices, duplicate invoices, overcharges, goods billed but never received, suspicious bank-detail changes, and large totals), each run 3 times per model.
- **The models:** Gemini 3.8 Flash (Google), GPT-6.1 Sol (OpenAI), and a budget model, Ling 3.0 Flash (inclusionAI), chosen by a fixed price-and-capability rule before any results.

What this means

For a workflow like this one, a budget model may cut AI model spending by about 98.5% with no loss in payment-decision accuracy. These tests can't show that for your workflow; testing on your own cases can.

Results

Model	Correct decisions	Note completeness	Cost per 1,000 invoices	Cost per 100,000 invoices
Gemini 3.8 Flash	100%	91.7%	$14.11	$1,411
GPT-6.1 Sol	100%	85.7%	$11.45	$1,145
Ling 3.0 Flash (budget)	100%	84.5%	$0.17	$17

Where the models differed: The only difference was how complete the explanation notes were. Gemini 3.8 Flash wrote the most complete notes (91.7%); GPT-6.1 Sol and Ling 3.0 Flash were close (85.7% and 84.5%). For every model, most missed details were in duplicate-invoice notes, such as leaving out the shared invoice number or the vendor. A missed detail never changed a payment decision, and the agent's instructions weren't tuned for any model.

Why you can trust these results

- **Decisions were checked by code, not opinion.** Each scenario has one correct action, and a run passes only if the agent takes it.
- **The budget model wasn't cherry-picked.** We chose it with a fixed price-and-capability rule before seeing any results.
- **The tasks couldn't be passed by guessing.** Giving the same answer to every invoice passes only 25% of them.
- **Small score gaps were tested for chance.** Every scenario ran 3 times. Overall scores were within 1.4 points of each other, and no difference was statistically significant after adjusting for three comparisons.

Before you switch models

Every model passed every scenario, so these tests show the budget model was enough for this workflow, not that the three models are equally capable. The scenarios were simplified: one invoice each, with no taxes, freight, or payment terms. With 24 scenarios, a true success rate as low as 86.2% can't be ruled out. Before moving production to a cheaper model, test it on your own workflows, including harder cases such as amounts exactly at a policy limit, conflicting rules, and lookalike records.

Run this on your agent

Free teardown

12 realistic tasks run against a test endpoint of your agent, with a private 2-page report.

Two-week sprint

A test suite built on your real workflows that re-runs in your CI whenever you change models or prompts.

One of our co-founders has designed agentic evaluation tasks and rubrics professionally.

Contact WeightedEvals@gmail.com

Method details

- **Models tested:** google/gemini-3.8-flash, openai/gpt-6.1-sol, and inclusionai/ling-3.0-flash, all at medium reasoning with default sampling settings. Test run October 24, 2026.
- **Budget model selection:** fixed in advance using a public model catalog's list prices that day. The rule required a production general-purpose model with tool use, at least 128,000 tokens of context, input pricing of $0.50 per million tokens or less, and an established lab other than Google, OpenAI, or Anthropic. Free, preview, and experimental models were excluded.
- **Note scoring:** a single AI judge (Claude Sonnet 5.5, with a locked prompt) rated note completeness. It affected note scores only, never whether a payment decision passed.
- **Statistics:** pass-rate 95% intervals are 86.2% to 100% for each model, computed per scenario (t intervals, or Wilson intervals when every result is identical). Model-to-model comparisons use paired differences with a Bonferroni correction for three comparisons. Every scenario passed on all 3 runs for every model.
- **Cost:** billed charges for running each agent only. The judge cost $0.96 and is an evaluation expense, excluded.
- **Methods we built on:** Miller, "Adding Error Bars to Evals" (uncertainty and paired comparisons); Yao et al., "τ-bench" (repeated-run reliability and end-state checks); Husain and Shankar on error analysis (grouping failures into categories).
- **Data:** task data, rubrics, and run logs are available on request.

Weighted Evals · WeightedEvals@gmail.com